according to its own interests". Hence, states, which play the game of balance, actually indulge in imbalance—in their favour.

- The balance of power game is a game for the great states although small and weaker states are vitally concerned with the outcome; they become mere spectators, or more often victims, rather than players.
- To maintain the balance there is a need for a balancer.

Hartman[12] looking back into history, identified four types of balance of power process since 1815.

1. "The balancer form in which the balancer promotes flexibility to a simple, two-bloc form restraining either bloc".
2. "The Bismarckian form in which the potential troublemaker is restrained by isolating her through a complex and flexible alliance system built on the utilization of the counter balancing interests of other powers".
3. "The Munich Era form in which the flexibility stems from the lack of coordination of interests upon the part of the likely victims of attack".
4. "The simple two bloc form such as existed in 1907–1914 and again from 1949–1963 or so, in which each bloc is the direct sole deterrent or restraining influence upon the other".